



FOCUS ON... SULFUR

Sulfur has been in use for centuries, from keeping food fresh to making rubber stronger.



▲ Sulfur is added to rubber in vehicle tyres in order to make them tougher.



▲ Sulfur-rich compounds are added to dried fruits and fresh food to stop them going bad.



▲ Car batteries use sulfuric acid to generate electric currents.

Sulfur

This yellow non-metal is found pure in nature as well as in combination with other elements in minerals. When sulfur burns, it melts into a blood-red liquid and produces a blue flame. It is also called brimstone, which means “burning stone”. Many ancient cultures thought that sulfur was the fuel that burned in the fires of the underworld.

ATOMIC MASS 32.06

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY Prehistoric

Rectangular crystals are odourless and brittle.

Yellow crystals of pure sulfur



16
S